

**Deal 1** Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

**Deal 3** Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 2  
 ♥ K 9 5 2  
 ♦ Q 8 5 4  
 ♣ 10 6 4

♠ A J 10 8 3

♥ A 3

♦ A J 7

♣ A Q 5



♠ 5

♥ Q J 10 8 7

♦ 9 6 2

♣ J 9 7 3

♠ K 9 7 6 4

♥ 6 4

♦ K 10 3

♣ K 8 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by North

With all the eliminations completed you are ready for the throw-in. Lead a ♥ from either hand. One of the defenders will win, (you don't care which), and will be end-played.

The defender who won the last trick cannot lead a trump because he has none. If he leads a ♥ or a ♣ you will get a ruff-sluff, ruffing in one hand while discarding a ♦ loser from the other. If he leads a ♦ you will get the free finesse you were hoping for all along.

If you finesse West for the ♦ Q you make the contract, but if you finesse East for that card you go down.

With an elimination play you make it no matter who holds the Queen.

South's 3 ♠ bid is a limit raise showing 10-12 points and good trump support. North is to play 6 ♠. East leads the ♥ Q.

This ♦ holding is the first example shown in the introduction.

With one certain ♥ loser you cannot afford to lose a ♦ also. You could guess which way to finesse and be correct half of the time. But an elimination play will work ALL of the time.

Win the first trick and play ♠ A, ♠ K. Trumps split 2-1.

Next play three rounds of ♣ s to eliminate that suit from both your and dummy's hand.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 9 7 6 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 7 3

♣ Q 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K 9 8 5 2

♦ A 10 8

♣ 10 9 6 3



♠ A J 10 8 3

♥ A 3

♦ Q 5 2

♣ A K 5

♠ Q 2

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ K 9 6 4

♣ J 7 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

are in. This will be taken by one of the defenders.

No matter which defender wins the ♥ he is end-played. A ♥ or a ♣ will give you a ruff-sluff, but if he leads a ♦ you cannot be prevented from establishing either your ♦ Q or ♦ J as a winner.

If you try to make a ♦ trick on your own you will fail. The first defender will play "second-hand-low" and the other defender will take your ♦ Q (or ♦ J).

Only by forcing them to start the ♦ s can you take a trick in the suit.

East is to play 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ Q.

This ♦ holding is the second example shown in the introduction.

This should remind you a lot of Deal 1. This time you have 1 ♥ loser and 3 ♦ losers. If you can force the opponents to lead ♦ s you can make a trick with the ♦ Q or ♦ J, avoiding one of those losers.

Win the first trick and play ♠ A, ♠ K. Trumps split 2-1.

Next play three rounds of ♣ s to eliminate that suit from you and dummy.

The eliminations are complete and it is time for the throw-in. Play the small ♥ from whichever hand you

**Board 5**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q 2  
♥ Q J 10 7  
♦ Q 8 6 4  
♣ J 7 4

♠ K 9 7 6 4  
♥ 6 4  
♦ K 10 3  
♣ K 8 2



♠ 5  
♥ K 9 8 5 2  
♦ J 5 2  
♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ A J 10 8 3  
♥ A 3  
♦ A 9 7  
♣ A Q 5

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 3 ♠          | Pass        | 6 ♠          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 6 ♠ by South |              |             |              |